

Cultivating Health: Community Food Gardens in Cochabamba

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Neuroscience, Computer Science
Public Health Pathway



CONNECTICUT
COLLEGE



Walter Commons Bessell UNSDG Internship with Fundación Alerta Verde
Mauricio Ramirez and the Office of Global Study and Engagement in the Walter Commons

Overview

- ❖ Went to Cochabamba, Bolivia
- ❖ Worked for a small NGO, Fundación Alerta Verde
- ❖ Alerta Verde specializes in environmental projects to help stabilize food insecurity faced by local impoverished communities. Provides aid to families and schools
- ❖ Aided in building and maintaining food gardens for the families within the project

Goals

- ❖ Improve Spanish
- ❖ Better communication/collaboration skills
- ❖ Embrace novelty with curiosity

My Project

Created a survey to interview family members within the project to gain insight into the impacts of the food gardens



Mission of Alerta Verde

Improve the quality of life for the wellbeing of current and future generations through environmental awareness, education, research, and advocacy projects in urban and rural areas

Outcomes/Take Away

- ❖ Experienced a new culture including its food, dance, and customs
- ❖ Made lifelong connections
- ❖ Globalized my perspective on accessibility

Future Plans

- ❖ Become more involved in initiatives that combine climate change awareness, sustainability, and community well-being
- ❖ Seek more opportunities to work in cross-cultural and global contexts
- ❖ Connect this experience to my work in the public health pathway